

Your Two Days, Hour by Hour

STADIO School of IT Student Innovation Hackathon 2026

Friday 21 to Saturday 22 August 2026 | All times SAST

Two days, one brief: use AI to solve a real business problem. Here is how the time is laid out and what you need to do at each point. The schedule is the same at every campus apart from the evening and overnight rows, which apply only to the campuses named.

Three things worth knowing

- Submissions close at 12:00 on Saturday. It is a hard deadline with no extensions, so build in buffer time.
- Mentors are on the floor throughout both days to guide you, not to judge you. Ask them anything. Judging is done by a separate panel of industry experts.
- You do not need a team to take part. Arrive at check-in on Friday morning and we will place you in one.

Day 1: Friday 21 August 2026

Time	What is happening	What to do
08:00	Check-in and registration	Arrive, sign in at the registration desk and find your team's spot. No team yet? Say so at the desk and we will place you in a team of four or five.
09:00 to 09:30	Opening ceremony	Be seated in the main hall by 08:55. You will get the brief, the rules and everything you need for the two days.
09:30 to 10:00	OfferZen talk	Stay in your seat for a talk on standing out and getting hired in the age of AI.
10:00	Hacking begins: sprint 1	Start building. Agree your idea quickly, split the work across the team, and put your hand up early when you get stuck.
12:30 to 13:00	Lunch	Take the full break and step away from the screen. Dietary options are labelled.
13:00	Hacking continues: sprint 2	Back to building. Keep testing as you go and grab a mentor the moment something is not working.
14:00	Elevator pitches	Mentors come to your team for a quick practice pitch. Say it out loud, keep it short, and use their feedback before Saturday.
18:00	Day 1 closes: Durbanville, Musgrave and Waterfall	Save and back up your work, pack up your belongings and head home. Be back on campus at 08:00 on Saturday.
18:30 to 19:30	Dinner: Centurion	Centurion only. Grab dinner and reset before the evening stretch.
19:30	Evening hacking: Centurion	Centurion only. Keep building. There is still help on the floor if you need it.
22:00	Quiet zone begins: Centurion	Centurion only. Keep the noise down from here so everyone around you can rest.

Day 2: Saturday 22 August 2026

Time	What is happening	What to do
06:00	Quiet zone ends	Centurion only. Normal noise levels resume and you can get straight back into it.
08:00	Campuses reopen	Durbanville, Musgrave and Waterfall: be back on campus and set up. Centurion: breakfast is served until 08:30.
08:30	Final sprint	Last stretch. Finish building, test what you have, and leave yourself time to package the submission properly.
11:00	One-hour warning	One hour left. Stop building and start submitting.
12:00	Submission deadline	Everything must be in by 12:00. Hard deadline, no extensions, so do not leave it to the buzzer.
12:00 to 13:00	Lunch	Eat, take a breath, and run through your pitch in your head.
12:00 to 13:30	Popular Vote	Walk the room, look at what the other teams built, and cast your vote before 13:30.
13:30	Move to the main hall	Start making your way to the main room, be ready to pitch at 13:45.
13:45 to 16:00	Final pitches and judging	The top 10 teams overall pitch to the industry panel. Stay and watch, it is the best part of the day.
16:00 to 16:30	Scores finalised	Stay in the hall and take a breather while the panel finalises the results.
16:30 to 17:00	Awards and closing	Winners are announced at the same time at every campus. Stay to the end, we finish at 17:00 sharp.